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Workers assembling Royal Enfield motorcycles at a factory in Oragadam, Tamil Nadu

subsidy as well as fast-track allotment of land.

The Make in Haryana 2026 Policy targets an investment of ₹5 lakh crore and creation of 10 lakh jobs over the next five years. Interestingly, *BT* data reveals that Haryana, which is a hub of several industries, including automotive and components, textiles and footwear as well as IT and ITeS, saw a decline in the number of factories between FY19 (11,835) and FY24 (10,389).

Mineral-rich Chhattisgarh, with its Industrial Policy 2024-30, aims to promote investment in agriculture products, mineral-based

core sector enterprises, and other resource-based industries across all development blocks. Vishwesh Kumar, former Joint Secretary, Department of Commerce and Industry, Chhattisgarh, says the state is looking to expand from its core sectors of steel, cement, power and aluminium to nearly 250 thrust sectors, including textiles, readymade garments, clothing, health, pharma and medical devices, IT and ITeS.

Sunil Sinha, Professor of Economics at Chandigarh-based Institute of Development and Communication, says certain states have a natural advantage. Tamil Nadu,

with its long coastline, is one of them. "On the whole, states in the South with a long coastline are well-suited for manufacturing," he says. Meanwhile, landlocked Haryana and UP, with proximity to the national capital, are also doing well.

Manufacturing is the way forward for India to sustain and boost its economy growth and provide meaningful jobs to citizens. States have begun to realise this, and several are working on new industrial policies. The next decade could bring some more contenders! **BT**

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